REGEXTEST v1.0 — Installation Guide

How to install it, where everything goes and what is new (October 2026 edition)

Author: Héctor Fortún Castañón.
Lic. Cybernetics-Mathematics
University of Havana

What RegexTest is

RegexTest is a test bench for regular expressions using the .NET engine: you type a pattern and a text and it shows the matches; it can also replace, split and generate the matching C# code. It comes with the manual **"Brief Introduction to Regular Expressions in C#"**. This guide only explains how to install it and where everything goes. The program screens are in Spanish.

Requirements

- Windows 10 or Windows 11.
- .NET Framework 4.8. It already comes with Windows 10 (version 1903 or later) and Windows 11, so normally nothing else needs to be installed.
- About 3 MB of free disk space.

Where to download it

The installer is the file `SetupRegexTestHF.msi`. It is downloaded from:

> https://github.com/HectorFortun2024/RegexTest/releases/latest

How to install it

1. Double-click `SetupRegexTestHF.msi`.
2. If the blue window **"Windows protected your PC"** appears, click **"More info"** and then **"Run anyway"** (the reason is explained in the box below).
3. If Windows asks **"Do you want to allow this app to make changes to your device?"** (Publisher: Unknown), click **"Yes"**.
4. Follow the wizard: accept the license, keep the proposed folder and click **"Install"**.
5. When it finishes, click **"Finish"**. RegexTest now appears in the Start menu and on the Desktop.

> **Why does Windows show a warning?**
> RegexTest is free and the installer has no digital signature (a code-signing certificate costs money every year). Windows warns about any unsigned program downloaded from the Internet, even if it is safe. Install it only if you downloaded it from the official link above.

Where everything goes

What	Where
Program	`C:\Program Files (x86)\Hector Fortun\RegexTestHF\RegexTest_2015.exe` (on 32-bit Windows: `C:\Program Files\Hector Fortun\RegexTestHF`)
Shortcut	Start menu › **RegexTestHF** folder › **RegexTest** Desktop › **RegexTest**
Manuals (PDF)	**User Manual - Regular Expressions (01_Mar_2024).pdf** (English) **Manual de Usuario -Expresiones Regulares (01_Mar_2024).pdf** (Spanish) In the program folder, with shortcuts in the Start menu and on the Desktop.
ASCII table	**ASCII.txt** and **ASCII - English.docx**, in the program folder.
License and README	**End User Agreement.rtf** and **README (Español).rtf** (Spanish and English), in the program folder.
Source code	https://github.com/HectorFortun2024/RegexTest

How to uninstall it

1. Open **Settings › Apps › Installed apps** (or Control Panel › Programs and Features).
2. Find **RegexTestHF**, click **"Uninstall"** and confirm.

The program, the manuals and all the shortcuts are removed.

What is new in this edition

- **Replace** and **Split** use the pattern and text currently typed (they used to use those of the last test).
- If the pattern is wrong, the program shows the .NET explanation (it used to say only "no match").
- 2-second limit per test: a pattern that keeps thinking, such as `(a+)+$`, no longer freezes the program.
- The generated C# code doubles the quotes correctly.
- The regular expressions manual has been reviewed and corrected against the .NET engine (`\w`, `\d`, `\b` classes, `\A` and `\Z` anchors, and others), with an up-to-date table of contents.
- New icon and MIT license: RegexTest is free and open source.

License

RegexTest is distributed under the **MIT** license: you may use, copy, modify and distribute it freely, including for commercial purposes. The full text is in **End User Agreement.rtf**.